
A COPY-PASTE PROMPT SYSTEM · BUILT FOR CLAUDE · 2026

The 8-Prompt Instagram System

Eight prompts that take you from "who am I even talking to" to a filled 60-day content calendar — audience research, positioning, hooks, scripts, captions and sales posts.

8

prompts, run in order,
each feeding the next

1

brand brief you write once
and reuse in all eight

60

days of planned content
at the end of the chain

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Why prompts fail

If you are still asking AI for "content ideas for my page", you will keep getting content that sounds like everyone else's. Not because the model is weak — because the prompt gave it nothing to work with. A generic prompt can only return the average of the internet.

The eight prompts in this document are built differently. Each one gives Claude a role, real context about your business, hard constraints, and a required output format. And each one takes the previous prompt's output as its input — so by prompt eight you are not generating ideas, you are assembling a calendar from decisions you already made.

THE RULE THIS WHOLE SYSTEM IS BUILT ON

Never ask AI to decide what you should have decided. Use it to research, structure, expand and stress-test — and keep the taste, the story and the point of view yours.

How to run this

- 01** Write the Brand Brief first (next page). It takes twenty minutes and it is the reason these prompts outperform whatever you are using now.
- 02** Run prompts 1 and 2 once. They produce your foundation — audience and pillars. You will only redo them when your offer changes.
- 03** Run prompts 3 to 7 whenever you create. These are your working tools.
- 04** Run prompt 8 monthly. It turns everything above into a dated calendar.
- 05** Save the outputs. Prompt 1's output becomes an input to almost every other prompt. Keep it in a doc you can paste from.

Anything in [SQUARE BRACKETS] is a blank you fill in. Everything else can be pasted as written.

The Brand Brief

Write this once. Paste it at the top of every prompt in this document, or save it as a Claude Project instruction so it is applied automatically to every chat. This single block is worth more than any clever prompt wording.

PASTE THIS AT THE TOP OF EVERY PROMPT

BRAND BRIEF

Business: [what you sell, in one plain sentence]
Who I serve: [specific audience - role, stage, situation]
What they are struggling with: [3 real problems, in their words]
What I actually deliver: [outcome, not features]
Price point: [range or exact]
My unfair advantage: [experience, results, access, or perspective nobody else in my niche has]
My point of view: [the opinion I will repeat for a year - what I believe that most of my niche does not]
Tone: [e.g. Hinglish, direct, no hype, slightly contrarian]
Language: [English / Hinglish / Hindi]
Platform: Instagram - [reels / carousels / both]
Current stage: [followers, posting frequency, what is working]
Proof I can reference: [client results, numbers, case studies, personal story]
What I will NOT post: [topics, formats or claims that are off-limits]

Two lines that do the heavy lifting

- My point of view. Without this, every output is neutral and forgettable. A stated opinion is what makes content sound like a person.
- What I will NOT post. Constraints improve output more than instructions do. Telling Claude what to avoid removes the generic middle it otherwise defaults to.

Set this up once in a Claude Project so every new chat already knows your business. Then your actual prompts get shorter and your outputs get sharper at the same time.

How the eight connect

This is a chain, not a menu. Each prompt's output is the next prompt's raw material.

#	Prompt	Takes in	Gives you
01	Audience Autopsy	Brand Brief	A researched profile of who you are talking to and the exact words they use
02	Positioning & Pillars	01	Your angle plus 4 content pillars with ratios
03	Hook Bank	01, 02	50 hooks sorted by psychological trigger
04	Reel Script Engine	03	Beat-by-beat scripts with timings
05	Carousel Architect	02, 03	Slide-by-slide carousels built for saves
06	Caption & CTA Writer	04 or 05	Captions written for the current algorithm
07	The Soft-Sell Post	01, 02	Sales posts that do not read as sales posts
08	60-Day Engine	02–07	A dated calendar with formats and pillars assigned

What each prompt is doing under the hood

- Prompts 1–2 are strategy. Slow, run rarely, highest leverage. Skipping these is why most AI content sounds generic.
- Prompts 3–7 are production. Fast, run often, disposable outputs.
- Prompt 8 is scheduling. It only works well if 1–7 have actually been run.

Audience Autopsy

Most content fails at the audience level, not the caption level. This prompt forces specificity before you write a single word.

When to run it

Once, at the start. Re-run only when your offer or audience changes.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

You are a demand researcher who specialises in finding the exact language a market uses to describe its own problems.

Build a deep profile of my ideal audience. Do not give me generic demographics. I need the psychological and situational detail that changes what I write.

Cover:

1. A one-paragraph portrait of one specific person in this audience, including their week, not just their job title.
2. Their top 5 problems - written in first person, in the exact words they would use, not marketing language.
3. What they have already tried that did not work, and why they blame themselves for it.
4. What they secretly want that they would not say out loud.
5. Their objections to paying someone like me - all of them, including the unflattering ones.
6. Where their attention already is: 5 accounts, creators or communities they follow, and what those get right.
7. The 15 words and phrases they actually use. Flag any industry jargon I should avoid because real buyers do not say it.
8. Three beliefs they hold that are wrong, and that my content could change.

Rules:

- Be specific enough that this could not describe a different niche.
- If a claim is a guess rather than something you can reason to, label it [ASSUMPTION] so I can verify it.
- No bullet-point fluff. Full sentences with real detail.

Then end with: the 3 questions you would need answered by me to make this profile significantly more accurate.

How to get more out of it

- Answer the three questions it asks at the end and paste them back. The second version is always noticeably better than the first.
- Push back on anything that sounds like a stereotype. Reply with "section 3 is generic — rewrite it using the specific situation from my brand brief".

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- Cross-check point 7 against your DMs and comments. Real audience language is already sitting in your inbox.

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Save the whole output. It becomes an input for prompts 2, 3, 6 and 7. The list in point 7 should sit next to you whenever you write a hook.

Positioning & Content Pillars

Four pillars, a ratio, and one point of view you repeat for a year. This is what makes a page recognisable instead of random.

When to run it

Once, after prompt 1. Revisit quarterly.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

[PASTE OUTPUT OF PROMPT 01]

You are a content strategist who builds positioning for creators and small businesses. You are blunt and you do not flatter.

Part A - Positioning

Give me 3 possible positioning angles for this page. For each:

- the one-line positioning statement
- who it attracts and who it deliberately repels
- the risk of choosing it
- how crowded that angle already is in this niche

Then recommend one, and explain why the other two are weaker for my specific situation.

Part B - Content pillars

Build exactly 4 content pillars. For each pillar give me:

- pillar name and the job it does (reach / trust / depth / sales)
- the % of my posts it should take
- 3 recurring formats that fit it
- 5 example topics, specific to my niche
- what a bad post in this pillar looks like, so I can avoid it

Part C - The through-line

Give me one point of view I can repeat across every pillar for the next 12 months without it getting stale - the idea people should associate with my name. Make it specific and slightly contrarian. Give me 5 different ways to say it so it does not sound repetitive.

Constraint: percentages in Part B must add to 100 and at least one pillar must be uncomfortable for me to post - that is where differentiation lives.

How to get more out of it

- Do not accept the first set of pillars. Ask: "which of these four would any competitor in my niche also have? Replace it."
- Ask for the ugly version. "Give me the version of this positioning that would get me unfollowed by the wrong people faster." Then decide how much of it you want.
- Write the through-line somewhere visible. If a post does not serve it, it is probably filler.

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Pin the four pillars and the through-line at the top of your content doc. Prompt 8 needs them to build the calendar, and prompt 3 needs them to keep hooks on-brand.

The Hook Bank

Reach is decided in the first three seconds. This prompt gives you fifty starts, organised by why they work — not fifty variations of the same sentence.

When to run it

Weekly, or whenever you sit down to batch content.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

[PASTE PILLARS FROM PROMPT 02]

You are a short-form video writer. You have written hooks for accounts that grew from zero to six figures of followers.

Write 50 hooks for my Instagram page on the topic: [TOPIC].

Organise them into these 10 categories, 5 hooks each:

1. Contrarian - challenges what my audience already believes
2. Mistake - names an error they are probably making right now
3. Specific number - a stat, price, or timeframe
4. Curiosity gap - opens a loop that must be closed
5. Callout - names the exact person this is for
6. Result - leads with an outcome, mine or a client's
7. Before/after - the shift, compressed into one line
8. Confession - something honest that costs me something to say
9. Question - the one they have already searched for
10. Warning - the cost of not knowing this

Rules:

- Maximum 12 words each. Say it out loud - if it needs a breath in the middle, cut it.
- Written in [LANGUAGE / TONE from brand brief].
- No 'in this video', no 'let me tell you', no 'here's why'.
- No hook that could be used by a different niche unchanged.
- Do not exaggerate results or invent numbers. If a hook needs a number, write it as [NUMBER] for me to fill in truthfully.

After the 50, pick the 5 you think will perform best and explain the specific reason for each - what tension it creates and who it stops mid-scroll.

How to get more out of it

- Feed it your best-performing past hook and add: "analyse why this worked for my audience, then write 15 more using the same underlying mechanism."
- Ask for the uncomfortable ten. "Now give me 10 hooks I would hesitate to post." Usually two of them are the best on the list.
- Reject anything you would not say out loud. If it feels like a caption template, it will sound like one on camera.

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Keep a running hook bank doc. Feed the winners into prompt 4 as scripts, and keep the runners-up — they become carousel slide-one text in prompt 5.

Reel Script Engine

A hook without structure is a hook that loses people at second seven. This produces beat-by-beat scripts with timings you can actually shoot.

When to run it

Every time you batch scripts. Run it once per hook you have chosen.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

You are a short-form video scriptwriter who writes for retention, not for applause.

Write a reel script using this hook: [PASTE CHOSEN HOOK]

Target length: [30 / 45 / 60] seconds.

Format: [talking head / voiceover with b-roll / screen recording]

Give me the script as a beat table with these columns:

TIMESTAMP | WHAT I SAY | WHAT IS ON SCREEN | WHY THIS BEAT EXISTS

Structural requirements:

- Hook lands in the first 3 seconds with no preamble at all.
- A re-hook or pattern break by second 8, before attention drops.
- One idea only. If a second idea appears, cut it and tell me it should be its own reel.
- Deliver real value before any CTA. The viewer should be able to do something differently even if they never contact me.
- CTA in the last 3 seconds, single and specific.

Writing rules:

- Write how I speak, in [LANGUAGE from brand brief]. Short sentences. No corporate phrasing.
- Every sentence must earn the next one. Mark any line that is filler with [CUT?] so I can remove it.
- No claims I have not given you evidence for.

After the table, give me:

- 3 alternative closing lines with different CTAs
- the one moment in this script most likely to lose viewers, and how to fix it
- an on-screen text overlay version of the whole script for sound-off viewers

How to get more out of it

- Ask for the shorter cut. "Now do this in 22 seconds without losing the point." Tighter almost always performs better.
- Read it out loud before shooting. Anything you stumble on is a line the model wrote and you would not say. Rewrite it in your own words.

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- Keep the "why this beat exists" column. Over a few weeks you will start writing the structure yourself and only using the prompt for speed.

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Shoot it. Then take the same script into prompt 6 for the caption — the caption should extend the reel, not repeat it.

Carousel Architect

Carousels earn saves and shares, and Instagram will re-surface them to people who swiped past. That makes structure worth more than design.

When to run it

Weekly. Best for the depth pillar from prompt 2.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

[PASTE PILLARS FROM PROMPT 02]

You are a carousel designer-writer who builds for saves and sends, not likes.

Build a [8-10] slide Instagram carousel on: [TOPIC]

For each slide give me:

SLIDE N | HEADLINE (max 8 words) | BODY (max 25 words) | VISUAL NOTE

Structure:

- Slide 1: the hook. It must work as a standalone image in the feed. No 'swipe to learn more' - earn the swipe.
- Slide 2: name the problem sharply enough that they feel seen. This slide has to survive being shown first, because the algorithm may re-surface the carousel starting from slide 2.
- Slides 3 to N-2: one idea per slide, each independently useful. A person who screenshots any single slide should still get value.
- Slide N-1: the summary slide. This is the one people save.
- Slide N: soft CTA, one action only.

Rules:

- No slide may be a filler transition.
- Language and tone per brand brief.
- Prioritise things a reader could apply today over theory.
- Include specific numbers, steps or examples wherever possible.

Then give me:

- 3 alternative slide-1 headlines
- a one-line summary of what makes this worth saving
- the strongest slide to screenshot and post as a standalone image

How to get more out of it

- Ask it to cut two slides. "Which two slides are weakest? Remove them and rewrite the flow." Shorter carousels usually finish better.
- Design the summary slide first. It is the one that gets saved and shared, so it deserves the most attention.
- Repurpose. A strong carousel is usually two or three reels. Ask: "turn slides 3, 5 and 7 into three separate reel hooks."

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Take slide 1's headline into your hook bank — carousel hooks and reel hooks are interchangeable. Take the whole carousel into prompt 6 for the caption.

Caption & CTA Writer

Captions now do real work: they carry the keywords Instagram uses for search, and they decide whether someone comments or scrolls.

When to run it

Every post.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

You are a direct-response copywriter writing Instagram captions.

Write captions for this post: [PASTE SCRIPT OR CAROUSEL CONTENT]

Goal of this post: [reach / saves / comments / DMs / sales]

Give me 3 caption variants:

- A - Short: under 40 words, punchy, for a post where the video already carries everything
- B - Story: 80-120 words, opens with a specific moment or number, not with a summary of the video
- C - Value: 120-180 words, teaches something the post did not have room for, so the caption is worth reading on its own

Every variant must:

- Open with a first line that works as a standalone hook, since that is all most people see before tapping 'more'
- Never begin by describing the video ('In this reel I show...')
- Include 3-5 keywords a person would actually search for on Instagram, worked into normal sentences - not stuffed
- End with ONE call to action, specific and low-friction
- Use line breaks so it is scannable on a phone
- Match my tone and language from the brand brief

Also give me:

- 5 hashtags maximum, mixing niche and broad. Explain each choice in four words or less.
- 3 comment-bait questions I could pin as the first comment, that a real person would want to answer
- one line I could add that would make someone send this post to a friend in DMs

How to get more out of it

- The last request matters most. DM sends are among the most heavily weighted signals for distribution right now — a caption line that prompts a share is doing more than a clever CTA.
- Ask for the first line alone, ten ways. Most people only ever read that one line.
- Do not stuff hashtags. Hashtag following was removed, and keywords in the caption now do more for discovery than a block of thirty tags.

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Post it. Then note in your calendar which variant you used — after a month you will know whether your audience responds to A, B or C, and you can stop generating three every time.

The Soft-Sell Post

Most creators either never sell or sell like a billboard. This prompt writes the version that converts without costing you the audience.

When to run it

Roughly one post in eight to ten. More when you have an active offer.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

[PASTE OUTPUT OF PROMPT 01 - especially the objections section]

You are a copywriter who specialises in selling without sounding like you are selling.

My offer: [what it is, what it costs, who it is for]

The single objection I want to dissolve in this post: [OBJECTION]

Write 4 different sales posts, each using a different mechanism:

1. Case study - one client, one specific problem, what changed, with real numbers. Mark every place I must insert a real number as [REAL NUMBER] - do not invent any.
2. Objection handler - address the objection directly and honestly, including where the objection is actually valid.
3. Teach-then-offer - genuinely useful content where the offer is only the obvious next step, mentioned once at the end.
4. Behind the process - show how the work actually happens, so the price makes sense without me defending it.

Every version must:

- Be honest. No fake urgency, no invented scarcity, no implied guarantee I have not given you.
- Name who the offer is NOT for. This builds more trust than anything else in the post.
- Have exactly one CTA.
- Sound like the same person who writes my normal content.

Then tell me which of the four fits my current audience stage ([FOLLOWER COUNT], [HOW WARM THEY ARE]) and why the other three would be premature or too soft.

How to get more out of it

- Fill in every [REAL NUMBER] yourself. Never post a figure the model produced — invented proof is the fastest way to lose a niche audience.
- Keep the "who this is not for" line. It is the highest-trust sentence in a sales post and the first thing people delete.
- Ask for the honest version. "Rewrite version 2 assuming my reader is sceptical of me specifically."

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Schedule it against your calendar from prompt 8, in the sales pillar. Sell on a rhythm, not on impulse — the rhythm is what stops it feeling like a lurch.

The 60-Day Content Engine

The payoff prompt. It only produces something useful if prompts 1, 2 and 3 have actually been run — which is exactly why most people's AI calendars are useless.

When to run it

Every 60 days. Review at the halfway point rather than rebuilding.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]
[PASTE PILLARS FROM PROMPT 02]
[PASTE YOUR BEST 15 HOOKS FROM PROMPT 03]

You are a content planner. Build me a 60-day Instagram calendar.

My capacity: [X] posts per week. Formats available to me:
[reels / carousels / stories / static].
Start date: [DATE].

Output as a table:

DAY	DATE	FORMAT	PILLAR	WORKING TITLE	HOOK	GOAL	NOTES
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Planning rules:

- Respect the pillar percentages from prompt 02 across the 60 days, and show me the final distribution so I can check it.
- Never place two posts from the same pillar back to back.
- Sales posts must be no more than 1 in 8, and never in the first 10 days.
- Build in 6 'proof' posts spread across the period - results, testimonials, behind the scenes.
- Include 4 posts explicitly designed to be sent to a friend in DMs, since that is a heavily weighted distribution signal.
- Build in 2 rest days per week where nothing is scheduled.
- Mark 8 posts as [BATCH] that could realistically be filmed in one session, and group them by set-up so I can shoot them together.
- Reuse each strong idea in a second format about 3 weeks later, and mark it [REPURPOSE].

Then give me separately:

1. A weekly production schedule - what to script, shoot, edit and post on which day, for one repeatable week.
2. The 5 posts in this calendar most likely to underperform, and what to replace them with if I run short on time.
3. What I should check at day 30 to decide whether to continue or change the plan.

How to get more out of it

— Give it your real capacity, not your ambitious one. A calendar you abandon in week two is worse than three posts a week you actually hit.

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- Ask for the batching plan first if time is your constraint: "regroup this entire calendar so I only need to film four times in 60 days."
 - Do not treat it as fixed. Anything that performs unusually well should displace whatever was scheduled next.

WHAT TO DO WITH THE OUTPUT

Paste it into a sheet, add a column for actual performance, and fill it in weekly. That column is what turns this from a content plan into a feedback loop — and it is the input for the bonus prompt on the next page.

BONUS

The monthly review prompt

The eight prompts build the system. This one keeps it honest. Run it at the end of every month with your actual numbers.

PROMPT

[PASTE BRAND BRIEF]

[PASTE PILLARS FROM PROMPT 02]

Here is last month's performance data:

[PASTE: post title | format | pillar | hook type | views |
saves | shares/sends | comments | profile visits | DMs]

You are a content analyst. Be direct - I want to know what is not working, not encouragement.

Tell me:

1. Which pillar is actually earning reach, and which one I am posting out of habit.
2. Which hook categories outperform for MY audience specifically, with the evidence from this data.
3. The relationship between sends/shares and reach in my data - what did the most-shared posts have in common?
4. Which posts got views but no profile visits, and what that suggests about my content-to-offer connection.
5. Three things to stop doing entirely.
6. Three specific experiments for next month, each with the number I should watch to judge it.

Rules:

- Do not tell me to 'post more consistently' or 'engage with my audience' - I want conclusions specific to this data.
- Where the sample is too small to conclude anything, say so plainly instead of guessing.

Sends and shares are worth paying disproportionate attention to. Content that gets sent to a friend in DMs is currently one of the strongest distribution signals on the platform — and it is a signal you can deliberately design for.

Seven rules for better output

- 01** Context beats cleverness. A plain prompt with your brand brief attached will beat an elaborate prompt with no context, every time.
- 02** Constraints improve quality more than instructions. "Maximum 12 words, no jargon, must not work for another niche" does more than "make it engaging".
- 03** Always specify the output format. Ask for a table with named columns and you get something usable. Ask for "ideas" and you get prose you have to reformat.
- 04** Iterate, do not restart. The second and third turn are where the quality is. "Section 3 is generic, rewrite it with specifics from my brief" beats opening a new chat.
- 05** Ask it to critique itself. "Which of these five is weakest and why?" surfaces problems you would otherwise post.
- 06** Ask for what you would not write. "Give me the version I would hesitate to post" is where differentiation hides.
- 07** Never let it invent proof. Numbers, results, testimonials and case studies come from you. Make the prompt mark them as blanks so you cannot post one by accident.

ONE HONEST WARNING

Instagram's leadership has publicly said the platform is prioritising raw, real human content over AI-generated material. Use these prompts for research, structure and speed — then say it in your own voice, on camera, in your own words. AI-shaped content that sounds AI-shaped is the one thing this system cannot save you from.

Before you post

Run any AI-assisted post through this. It takes thirty seconds and it is the difference between content that sounds like you and content that sounds like a tool.

- ☐ Would I say this sentence out loud to a person? If not, rewrite it
- ☐ Is there a specific number, name, place or moment in here — or is it all general?
- ☐ Could a competitor in my niche post this unchanged? If yes, it is not differentiated
- ☐ Does it contain a claim, figure or result I cannot personally back up?
- ☐ Does the first line work alone, with no context?
- ☐ Is there exactly one call to action?
- ☐ Does it serve my through-line from prompt 2?
- ☐ Have I removed every phrase that exists only to sound professional?
- ☐ Would I send this to a friend? If not, why would anyone else?

The seven-day setup

Day	What you do	Time
1	Write the Brand Brief. Set it up as a Claude Project instruction.	30 min
2	Run prompt 1. Answer its follow-up questions, run it again.	45 min
3	Run prompt 2. Argue with the output until the pillars are genuinely yours.	45 min
4	Run prompt 3. Build your first hook bank of 50.	30 min
5	Run prompts 4 and 5. Write three reel scripts and one carousel.	60 min
6	Run prompt 8. Build the 60-day calendar and the batching plan.	45 min
7	Film the first batch. Post one.	Half a day

Total setup: roughly four hours across a week. After that, prompts 3 to 7 take minutes per post because the thinking is already done.

Platform notes & sources

Instagram changes constantly. These are the current signals the prompts are built around, checked July 2026 — verify anything you plan to repeat publicly, because this section ages faster than the rest of the document.

What the prompts assume	Where it comes from
Watch time, likes per reach and sends per reach are the three ranking signals that matter most	Adam Mosseri, Head of Instagram, confirmed publicly and repeated through 2026
DM sends carry outsized weight for reaching people who do not follow you	Instagram creator communications; widely reported across 2026 platform analyses
Hashtag following has been removed; caption keywords now drive search discovery	Instagram product change, 2025–26; use a handful of hashtags, not thirty
Carousels get a second chance — the algorithm may re-surface them starting from slide 2	Adam Mosseri, on carousel performance
Reels between roughly 30 and 90 seconds tend to perform best for engagement, though up to 3 minutes is shown to non-followers	Platform guidance and 2026 benchmark reporting
Raw, human content is being prioritised over AI-generated material	Mosseri year-end memo, December 2025

Engagement-rate benchmarks vary widely between reports (Sprout Social, Social Insider and Dash Hudson all publish different figures depending on account size and sample). Use them as direction, not as targets — your own month-over-month numbers are the only benchmark that matters.

THAT'S THE SYSTEM

The prompt is easy. The brief is the hard part.

Everyone has access to the same model. The difference in output comes almost entirely from what you put in front of it — how specifically you know your audience, how clearly you have chosen your angle, and how honest you are willing to be about what you actually believe.

Spend the twenty minutes on the Brand Brief. Then these eight prompts will do more for you than a hundred saved prompt screenshots ever will.

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If you modify one of these prompts into something better, send it to me. The best versions of this playbook have always come from people who broke it first.

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